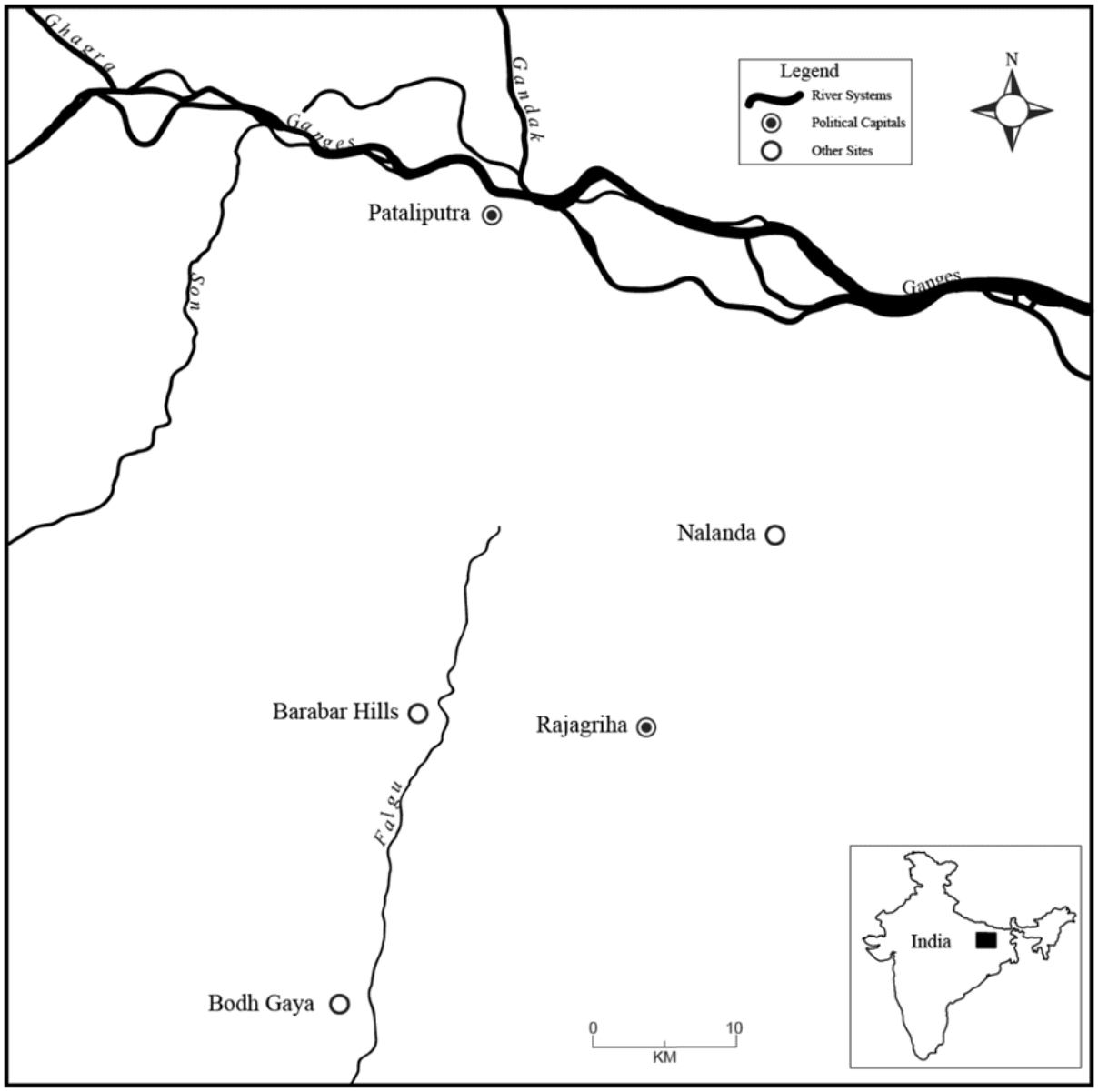
Ashoka’s grandfather Chandragupta was the reigning king, the famous Greek writer-traveller-diplomat Megasthenes spent some time in the city and left behind a vivid and, as confirmed by modern excavations, fairly accurate description of the dimensions and character of the city. So we can be reasonably certain that the city where Ashoka and his siblings spent their growing years was as described in the narrative of the Greek visitor.



Map 2: Magadha’s political capitals—Rajagriha and Pataliputra